

★ = high chance of appearing (ranked against past IBPS PO Mains papers and 2026 bank exams). Each answer is followed by the key fact and its source. Marking: +1.2 right, -0.30 wrong.

1. In its bi-monthly monetary policy of 3-5 August 2026, the RBI's Monetary Policy Committee kept the policy repo rate unchanged. What are the policy repo rate and the Standing Deposit Facility (SDF) rate after this policy? ★

Ans (B) Repo 5.25%, SDF 5.00%

On 5 Aug 2026 the MPC voted unanimously to hold repo at 5.25% with a neutral stance, its fourth straight pause. The corridor is SDF 5.00% and MSF/Bank Rate 5.50% (Business Standard / CNBC TV18, 5 Aug 2026).

2. In the August 2026 monetary policy, how did the RBI revise its projections of real GDP growth and CPI inflation for FY 2026-27? ★

Ans (C) GDP raised to 6.7%; CPI inflation lowered to 5.0%

The 5 Aug 2026 policy raised the FY27 GDP growth forecast to 6.7% and cut the FY27 CPI inflation forecast to 5.0% (New Indian Express / Moneycontrol / IIFL, 5 Aug 2026).

3. Under the Reserve Bank - Integrated Ombudsman Scheme (RB-IOS), 2026, which came into effect on 1 July 2026, what is the maximum compensation the RBI Ombudsman can award for consequential loss, and for mental agony, harassment and expenses? ★

Ans (C) Rs 30 lakh and Rs 3 lakh

RB-IOS 2026 took effect on 1 Jul 2026 and replaced RB-IOS 2021, which allowed Rs 20 lakh + Rs 1 lakh. It allows up to Rs 30 lakh for consequential loss plus Rs 3 lakh for non-financial loss, Rs 33 lakh in total (Business Standard 1 Jul 2026 / Economic Times 14 Jul 2026).

4. Under the RBI's final framework for compensating victims of small-value digital frauds (net loss up to Rs 50,000), notified in June 2026 and effective from 1 January 2027, how much compensation does an eligible customer receive? ★

Ans (A) 85% of the net loss or Rs 25,000, whichever is lower

The RBI's final framework (24 Jun 2026) pays 85% of the net loss, capped at Rs 25,000, as a once-in-a-lifetime benefit, effective 1 Jan 2027 (Indian Express / Livemint, 24-25 Jun 2026).

5. NPCI has announced a Merchant Discount Rate (MDR) on person-to-merchant (P2M) UPI transactions with effect from 15 October 2026. What is the MDR, and on transactions above what value does it apply? ★

Ans (D) 0.4% on transactions above Rs 2,000

NPCI set a 0.4% MDR on P2M UPI payments above Rs 2,000 from 15 Oct 2026, capped at Rs 300 (reached at Rs 75,000). The Supreme Court refused to stay it on 28 Sep 2026 (Entrackr 15 Sep / Indian Express 28 Sep 2026).

6. In August 2026, NPCI International Payments Ltd (NIPL) signed an agreement with National Interbank Processing Centre (NIPC), operator of the HUMO payment system, so that Indian travellers can pay with UPI by scanning the national QR code 'UZQR'. NIPC belongs to which country? ★

Ans (A) Uzbekistan

NIPL partnered with Uzbekistan's NIPC (the HUMO operator) to accept UPI through UZQR. The deal was announced on 31 Aug 2026 and no rollout date has been set yet (Economic Times 31 Aug / MediaNama 1 Sep 2026).

7. The RBI released the list of Upper Layer NBFCs (NBFC-UL) for 2026-27 on 6 August 2026. Which of the following is NOT one of the new entrants to the list? ★

Ans (D) Tata Sons

The FY27 NBFC-UL list grew to 17 entities. REC, PFC, IRFC and HUDCO were added, while Tata Sons stayed on from before (The Statesman 6 Aug / Adda247 7 Aug 2026).

8. In September 2026, the Reserve Bank of India approved Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC) to acquire an aggregate holding of up to 9.99% of the paid-up share capital or voting rights of which bank? ★

Ans (D) ICICI Bank

The RBI approved LIC to acquire up to 9.99% of ICICI Bank, with one year to complete the acquisition (Business Standard / BusinessLine / Moneycontrol, 5 Sep 2026).

9. According to the RBI's Financial Stability Report (June 2026), what was the Gross Non-Performing Assets (GNPA) ratio of scheduled commercial banks in March 2026, a multi-decadal low? ★

Ans (C) 1.8%

FSR June 2026: SCB GNPA fell to a multi-decadal low of 1.8% in Mar 2026, and stress tests show it could edge up to 1.9% by FY28 (Economic Times / Business Today, 30 Jun 2026).

10. In July 2026, the Government of India approved an RBI proposal to put polymer (plastic) banknotes into field trials. Which denominations are included, with 1 billion notes of each? ★

Ans (C) Rs 10 and Rs 20

The government approved field trials of 1 billion each of Rs 10 and Rs 20 polymer notes (2 billion in total, about Rs 3,000 crore) and said there is no plan to replace paper notes (Indian Express / Economic Times, 27 Jul 2026).

11. Under the RBI (Lending Against Gold and Silver Collateral) Directions, which took effect on 1 April 2026, what is the maximum Loan-to-Value (LTV) ratio for a gold loan of up to Rs 2.5 lakh? ★

Ans (D) 85%

The gold and silver collateral norms, effective 1 Apr 2026, set LTV at 85% for loans up to Rs 2.5 lakh, 80% for Rs 2.5-5 lakh and 75% above Rs 5 lakh (Indian Express 7 Jun 2026 / Upstox Apr 2026).

12. Which of the following statements about banking in India is INCORRECT? ★

Ans (D) From 1 April 2026, DICGC charges all insured banks a flat premium of 12 paise per Rs 100 of assessable deposits

From 1 Apr 2026, DICGC charges a risk-based premium, from 8 paise per Rs 100 for the safest banks up to 12 paise, in place of the old flat 12 paise. The LRS, UTR and CD statements are correct (Economic Times / BusinessLine, 6-7 Feb 2026).

13. India's CPI (retail) inflation for August 2026, released by MoSPI on 14 September 2026, was 4.82%. What is the base year of the new CPI series behind this figure? ★

Ans (A) 2024

MoSPI/PIB press release, 14 Sep 2026: August 2026 CPI inflation was 4.82% (up from 4.45% in July) and food inflation 5.95%, on the new series with base 2024=100, which replaced the old 2012-base series.

14. Which of the following is NOT a criterion for horizontal devolution of central taxes among states under the 16th Finance Commission (Chairman: Arvind Panagariya) for 2026-31?

Ans (A) Tax and fiscal effort

PRS summary of the 16th FC report, tabled 1 Feb 2026: states' share stays at 41%. 'Tax and fiscal effort' (2.5% under the 15th FC) was dropped, and the new 'contribution to GDP' criterion gets 10%. Income distance is 42.5%, population 17.5%, and demographic performance, area and forest are 10% each.

15. Consider these statements about the PM Surya Sarovar Yojana (PM-SSY), approved by the Union Cabinet on 31 July 2026: I. Its total outlay is Rs 5,070 crore. II. SECI is the implementing agency, under the Ministry of New and Renewable Energy. III. It targets 5,000 MW of floating solar PV with co-located storage of at least 2 hours. Which of these statements is/are correct? ★

Ans (D) All of the above

Cabinet, 31 Jul 2026 (Insights IAS/StudyIQ/PIB): PM-SSY has an outlay of Rs 5,070 crore for 5,000 MW of floating solar with storage of at least 2 hours (10,000 MWh). CFA is Rs 1 crore per MW, MNRE is the nodal ministry and SECI implements the scheme.

16. The Union Cabinet approved the continuation of PM-KISAN from 2026-27 to 2030-31. What total financial outlay was approved for this period?

Ans (C) Rs 3.15 lakh crore

Cabinet decision, 31 Jul 2026 (PMIndia/DD News): PM-KISAN continues to 2030-31 with an outlay of Rs 3.15 lakh crore. The benefit is Rs 6,000 a year, paid in 3 equal DBT instalments.

17. The India-UK Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA) came into force on 15 July 2026. Which other India-UK agreement took effect on the same day?

Ans (C) Double Contribution Convention

DD India/PIB, Jul 2026: CETA and the Double Contribution Convention (the social security pact) both took effect on 15 Jul 2026. CETA gives duty-free access to about 99% of India's exports to the UK.

18. What was the theme of the 18th BRICS Summit held at Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi on 12-13 September 2026? ★

Ans (C) Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability

PMIndia/DD News, Sep 2026: India hosted the 18th summit at Bharat Mandapam on 12-13 Sep 2026, its 4th chairship after 2012, 2016 and 2021, and the summit adopted the New Delhi Declaration. The other options are the themes of Brazil 2025, Russia 2024 and South Africa 2023.

19. Where did India finish in the medal table at the 2026 Commonwealth Games held in Glasgow?

Ans (D) 4th

Glasgow CWG 2026 (Aug 2026): India finished 4th with 39 medals (13 gold, 17 silver, 9 bronze), including a record 7 boxing golds, even though wrestling and shooting were left out. Australia topped the table.

20. Which country won the 2026 FIFA World Cup (hosted by the USA, Canada and Mexico) by beating Argentina 1-0 after extra time in the final?

Ans (C) Spain

CNBC/Indian Express, 19-20 Jul 2026: Spain beat Argentina 1-0 after extra time at MetLife Stadium, New Jersey, with an extra-time goal by Ferran Torres. It is Spain's 2nd title, after 2010.